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Inventor(s)	Peters; Riley et al.

Self-adhering duct insulation product

Abstract

A duct insulation product may include an insulation material and a moisture barrier material coupled with the insulation material. The moisture barrier material may form an outer surface of the duct insulation product. The moisture barrier material may include at least one closure flap along at least one side of the moisture barrier material. The closure flap may extend beyond a periphery of the insulation material along at least one side of the insulation material. At least a portion of an inner surface of the closure flap may include an adhesive material.

Inventors: Peters; Riley (Denver, CO), O'Kane; Nicholas (Centennial, CO), Kulprathipanja; Ames (Broomfield, CO), Powell; Jerry Kenneth (Weatherford, TX)

Applicant: JOHNS MANVILLE (Denver, CO)

Family ID: 89324674

Assignee: Johns Manville (Denver, CO)

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Primary Examiner: Deal; David R**Background/Summary****BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION**

(1) Ductwork, or ducting, is often used to transport one or more fluids between destinations. For example, ductwork may be used to transport air from heating, ventilation and air-conditioning (HVAC) equipment throughout a building. The ductwork is made from a metal material, such as stainless steel, galvanized steel, carbon steel (black iron), aluminum, titanium, etc., or from a plastic material, such as polyvinyl chloride (PVC), chlorinated polyvinyl chloride (CPVC), fiber reinforced plastic (FRP), polypropylene (PP), polyethylene (PE), ceramic, fiberglass, or concrete material, etc.

(2) During fluid transportation, the fluid may be subjected to heating and/or cooling from the surrounding environment. For example, the fluid may be transported in either a hot or cold state relative to the surrounding environment, which induces heat transfer to or from the fluid and ducts. HVAC systems are a common example of systems that routinely utilize various duct configurations to transport hot or cold fluids. Due to the conductive nature of the ducts (especially metal ducts), heat may be conducted to or from the fluid during transportation. The addition or removal of heat may result in the decreased efficiency of a system and/or increased time and/or expense in operating the system. For example, in HVAC systems, the addition of heat to cooled fluids may result in loss of efficiency for a cooling unit and may also result in increased expense because of

increased operating time and energy needed to achieve a desired cooling level.

(3) To reduce heat transfer during fluid transportation, duct insulation products are commonly installed on one or more sections of the ductwork to retard the flow of heat to or from the ducts. Commonly, one or more sections of duct are fitted with a duct insulation product where the sections of duct are generally fully encased within the duct insulation product. Separate sections of the duct insulation product are often coupled together via adhesive tapes. The outer surface of the duct insulation product is often designed to enhance the visual appeal of the ductwork and serve as a means for sealing the duct insulation product about the ducts of the ductwork. In addition, the various materials of the duct insulation product often serve one or more important functions (e.g., restricting water vapor transmission; resisting mold, mild, and/or fungal growth; providing puncture resistance, tensile strength, and/or durability; resisting UV, handling, environmental, and/or shipping damage, etc.).

(4) To perform some of these functions, it is critical that the outer material of the duct insulation product be sealed and remain sealed over the life of the duct insulation product. For example, the duct insulation product may include one or more materials that restrict the transmission of water vapor or other environmental contaminants through the laminate. Generally, a duct insulation product is required to have a water vapor transmission rate of no greater than 0.02 perms. If the duct insulation product is not able to seal and/or remain sealed over the life of the product, the material that functions as a water vapor barrier or retarder may be compromised or circumvented because water vapor and/or other contaminants may freely flow through the unsealed portion of the duct insulation product.

(5) Leakage of water vapor and/or other contaminants into the duct insulation product's interior may cause a variety of problems for the insulated duct and/or surrounding objects including: condensation of water on the ducts; mold, mildew, or fungal growth; duct corrosion or degradation; staining of the duct insulation product and/or surrounding objects; water drip damage; loss of the duct insulation product's insulating value, etc. Hence, the integrity of the duct insulation product's seal is critically important to the functionality of the duct insulation product.

BRIEF SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

(6) The present technology relates to insulation products, such as duct, pipe, or other insulation products. In some embodiments, the insulation product, such as a duct insulation product, may include an insulation material and a moisture barrier material coupled with the insulation material. The moisture barrier material may form an outer surface of the duct insulation product. The moisture barrier material may include at least one closure flap along at least one side of the moisture barrier material. The closure flap may extend beyond a periphery of the insulation material along at least one side of the insulation material. At least a portion of an inner surface of the closure flap may include an adhesive material.

(7) In some embodiments, the duct insulation product may be flexible. The insulation material may be or include fiberglass. The moisture barrier material may be or include a foil scrim kraft paper laminate, fiberglass reinforced faces, a poly facing, polyisocyanurate, an all service jacketing facing. The adhesive material may be characterized by a thickness of greater than or about 0.01 mm. The adhesive material may be characterized by a peel strength of greater than or about 60 ounces per inch. The adhesive material may be disposed along substantially an entire length of the moisture barrier material. The adhesive material may be or include double-sided tape. The duct insulation product may be rolled up prior to installation. The adhesive material may be applied to the closure flap prior to rolling up the insulation material.

(8) Some embodiments of the present technology may directed to duct insulation systems. The systems may include a plurality of duct insulation products. Each duct insulation product may include an insulation material and a moisture barrier material coupled with the insulation material. The moisture barrier material may extend beyond a periphery of the insulation material along at least one side of the insulation material to form a closure flap. At least a portion of an inner surface

of the closure flap may include an adhesive material. The adhesive material of the closure flap of a first duct insulation product may couple with and secure a second duct insulation product.

(9) In some embodiments, the duct insulation system may be positioned around one or more ducts. The adhesive material may be characterized by a thickness of greater than or about 0.01 mm. The adhesive material may be characterized by a width of less than or about 8.0 inches. The moisture barrier material may include a length at least double a width of the moisture barrier material. The adhesive material may be disposed along substantially an entire length of the moisture barrier material. A first end of each duct insulation product may be defined by a male shiplap profile. A second end of each duct insulation product may be defined by a female shiplap profile. The closure flap and the adhesive material may be defined on at least one inner surface of the second end.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) A further understanding of the nature and advantages of the disclosed technology may be realized by reference to the remaining portions of the specification and the drawings.

(2) FIG. 1 illustrates is a schematic perspective view of a duct insulation product according to embodiments of the present invention.

(3) FIG. 2 illustrates a partial schematic perspective view of a duct insulation product according to embodiments of the present invention.

(4) FIG. 3 illustrates a side elevation view of duct insulation product with a closure flap according to embodiments of the present invention.

(5) FIG. 4 illustrates an isometric view of duct insulation system with a shiplap closure flap according to embodiments of the present invention.

(6) FIG. 5 schematically depicts a duct insulation manufacturing method according to embodiments of the present invention.

(7) Several of the figures are included as schematics. It is to be understood that the figures are for illustrative purposes, and are not to be considered of scale unless specifically stated to be of scale. Additionally, as schematics, the figures are provided to aid comprehension and may not include all aspects or information compared to realistic representations, and may include exaggerated material for illustrative purposes.

(8) In the appended figures, similar components and/or features may have the same reference label. Further, various components of the same type may be distinguished by following the reference label by a letter that distinguishes among the similar components. If only the first reference label is used in the specification, the description is applicable to any one of the similar components having the same first reference label irrespective of the letter.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE INVENTION

(9) The ensuing description provides exemplary embodiments only, and is not intended to limit the scope, applicability, or configuration of the disclosure. Rather, the description of the exemplary embodiments will provide those skilled in the art with an enabling description for implementing one or more exemplary embodiments. It being understood that various changes may be made in the function and arrangement of elements without departing from the spirit and scope of the invention as set forth in the appended claims.

(10) Embodiments of the present invention are directed to insulation products such as duct insulation products. The duct insulation products may include an insulation material and a moisture barrier material. At least a portion of the moisture barrier material may extend beyond a periphery of the insulation material along at least one side of the insulation material, thereby forming a closure flap. An adhesive material on an inner surface of the closure flap may be used to seal the moisture barrier to a lateral edge portion of the moisture barrier material of the same duct insulation

product or of a second duct insulation product. The closure flap and adhesive material may eliminate the need for stapling the moisture barrier material and applying an adhesive or tape over the stapled portion as done in conventional installations. Thus, the closure flap and adhesive material may reduce installation time and may even improve the sealing properties of the insulation material, as no punctures in the moisture barrier material are necessary. While discussed primarily in the context of duct insulation, it will be appreciated that the features described herein may be applied to other insulation applications, including piping, tubing, and the like. Additionally, while generally discussed in terms of duct wraps, it will be appreciated that the insulation products described herein may be utilized as duct liners, duct boards, pipe insulation, insulation batts, and/or other types of insulation products.

(11) Referring now to FIG. 1, a duct insulation product **100** may include an insulation material **104** that may include an outer surface (i.e., the outside of the core that directly contacts the laminate) and an inner surface **114**. While shown as having a generally rectangular shape, it will be appreciated that the insulation product **100** may have other shapes to fit about ducts, pipes, and/or other structures having non-circular cross-sections. For example, the insulation product **100** may be affixed about an exterior surface of a structure having a generally circular cross-section in some embodiments. The insulation product **100** may include a layer of insulation material **104**, an inner surface of which may form the inner surface **114** of the insulation product **100**. The insulation material **104** may provide thermal and/or acoustic insulating properties to the duct insulation product **100**. In one embodiment, the insulation material **104** may be a fibrous material (e.g., fiberglass, mineral wool, refractory ceramic fiber, chopped strand fiber glass, etc.). In other embodiments the insulation material **104** may be a foam (e.g., phenolic foam, polyisocyanurate, polyolefin, polystyrene, polyurethane), a polymer, foam glass, microporous insulation, or any other material that provides insulation.

(12) The inner surface **114** may be configured to correspond with a specific duct outer profile (e.g., rectangular ducting having sizes from about 3 inches by about 7 inches up to about 35 inches by about 40 inches or round ducting with a diameter between about 4 inches and about 41 inches, etc.). In other embodiments, the duct insulation product **100** may be a trim-to-fit product that may be cut to a desired size during installation, and may enable the insulation product **100** to be used to insulate ducts and/or other structures of different sizes and/or shapes. For example, the insulation product **100** may have at least one dimension (e.g., length and/or width) that is larger than a duct (or other structure to be insulated) such that the insulation product **100** may be trimmed, onsite to fit about the structure. In embodiments, the insulation product **100** may include a number of generally planar segments that are separable and/or pivotal relative to one another, and may include opposing ends that may be overlapped and/or joined such that the insulation product **100** may be secured about a structure that includes a non-circular cross-section.

(13) Surrounding and encasing the insulation material **104** may be a laminate jacket or simply a laminate **102**. The laminate **102** may have a thickness that includes one or more layers of various materials as described below. The laminate **102** may be roughly co-extensive with the insulation material **104** and bonded to the outer surface of the insulation material **104**. The laminate **102** may be positioned so that an edge portion extends parallel and adjacent to the insulation material **104**. A peripheral edge of the laminate **102** may extend beyond a peripheral edge of the insulation material **104** to form at least one closure flap or end **108** that extends along all or a portion of a length of one or more edges of the insulation product **100**. Each closure end **108** may be secured the laminate **102** to itself in a closed position fully encasing the insulation material **104** within the laminate **102** (or within multiple laminates that are joined together). For example, the closure end may be fixed to the laminate **102** of another insulation product **100** or to the laminate **102** itself. As will be further described below, the closure end **108** may include an adhesive material on an inner surface of the laminate **102** that adheres to the laminate **102** of another insulation product **100** or to the laminate **102** itself.

(14) Maintaining a sealed closed position may be a desirable function of the closure end **108** so that the insulated pipe and/or insulation material are not subjected to one or more environmental elements, such as water vapor. If the closure end **108** is not able to seal or remain sealed (e.g., the closure end **108** curls backward and/or at least partially disengages from the surface on which the closure end **108** is adhered) after being adhered to the laminate's (or another laminate's) outer surface, then water vapor and/or other contaminants may pass between the closure end **108** and thereby leak or pass into the interior of the duct insulation product (i.e., pass to the encased duct (or other structure) and insulation material). Water vapor and/or other contaminants that pass into the laminate's interior may cause condense on the ducts; causing corrosion or degradation; mold, mildew, and/or fungal growth; water drip damage; staining of the laminate and/or surrounding objects; loss of the duct insulation product's insulating value; etc. The laminate **102** may include one or more flame retardants, fungi growth inhibiting agents, charge dissipators, and/or other additives to enhance the performance of the laminate.

(15) FIG. 2 depicts a laminate **200** according to one embodiment of the present invention. FIG. 2 shows portions of the laminate **200** broken away to reveal the various layers of the laminate **200**. The laminate **200** may include an outer layer composed of a foil or metallized polymeric film sheet **208**. The polymeric film sheet **208** may be selected as the laminate's **200** outer layer to provide one or more of the following advantages:

(16) shielding porous media sheet **204** and/or insulation material **202** from water vapor absorption; protecting against UV damage; protecting against mold, mildew, or fungal growth; providing a smooth, unwrinkled, visually appealing outer surface; etc. Polymeric film materials may generally provide a smoother, more visually appealing outer surface when compared with traditional laminates.

(17) In embodiments, sheet **208** may include a layer that is made of aluminum foil or metallized polyethylene terephthalate (MPET) between about 0.48 mm and about 100.0 mm in thickness (i.e., between about 48 and 100 gauge in thickness). The aluminum foil or MPET may provide a nearly impermeable fluid vapor barrier to fluids that are external to and surrounding the pipe insulation product. By using the foil or metallized polymeric film sheet **208**, fluid may be passed through the insulated duct, and one or more environmental elements (e.g., water vapor) in the surrounding environment may be restricted (or kept) from penetrating through laminate to the duct. For example, the foil or metallized polymeric film sheet **208** may be nearly impermeable to water vapor, which protects the insulated duct from corrosion, loss of insulating value, mold growth, etc. The foil or metallized polymeric film sheet **208** may enable the laminate **200** to provide a water vapor transmission rate of less than 0.02 perms. If the closure end **108** becomes unsealed, however, the water vapor barrier may be circumvented as water vapor may freely flow between the unsealed portion of the laminate.

(18) The laminate **200** may also include a scrim **206** that may include a mesh of a plurality of fibers. The scrim **206** may function to reinforce and strengthen the laminate **200** and thereby provide increased tensile strength, puncture resistance, etc. The scrim **206** may be made of fiberglass reinforcing yarn, such as but not limited to a G75 or H110 yarn. In addition, the yarn may be configured to be from 2 to 6 strands per inch in both the machine and cross machine directions, with a typical scrim being about 5 strands per inch in both directions. In some embodiments the scrim **206** may be made of polyester strings or any other synthetic string. The scrim **206** may be positioned immediately adjacent to the foil or metallized polymeric film sheet **208** or may be positioned anywhere else within the laminate (i.e., may be positioned immediately adjacent the polymeric film sheet **202**).

(19) The laminate **200** may also include a porous media sheet **204**. The porous media sheet **204** may be positioned immediately adjacent to the scrim **206** or may be positioned anywhere else within the laminate **200**. The porous media sheet **204** may be a kraft paper that is between about 25 and 45 pounds/3000 square feet and may include one or more additives to enhance the performance

of the laminate **200** (e.g., fire retardant additives and/or anti-microbial agents to prevent mold or fungal growth and prevent propagation of smoke and/or fire). In one embodiment, the porous media sheet **204** may be a kraft paper between 25 and 35 pounds/3000 square feet to provide increased seal integrity and/or closure of the closure end **108** without significantly degrading beneficial properties of the laminate (e.g., tensile strength, puncture resistance, handling damage resistance, etc.). In one specific embodiment, the kraft paper may be roughly 30 pounds/3000 square feet to provide optimal levels of closure end seal integrity and laminate properties.

(20) Alternatively, the porous media sheet **204** may be other materials such as a fiberglass mat, synthetic mat, paper, etc. Likewise, in some embodiments the scrim **206** and porous media sheet **204** may be replaced by a single, preferably porous, material. The porous nature of the porous media sheet **204** may allow absorption and retention of one or more additives within the porous media sheet layer, which may provide one or more enhancements to the laminate **200** (e.g., flame and smoke propagation resistance; mold, mildew, and/or fungal growth resistance; etc.).

(21) In laminates that employ a kraft paper, the use of a heavy weight kraft paper (e.g., 40-45 pounds/3000 square feet) may be preferred because such papers provide several advantages over lighter weight papers (e.g., 25-35 pounds/3000 square feet). For example, heavier weight kraft papers may provide structural advantages including increased durability, support, tensile strength, puncture resistance, handling damage resistance, environmental damage resistance, shipping damage resistance, etc. and/or may provide aesthetic advantages including a smoother, visually appealing, and more abuse resistant the outer surface. Heavy weight kraft papers, however, may increase that stiffness and rigidity of the laminate, which may increase a laminate's closure end seal failure due to the laminate's resistance to bending or curling towards the closed position and remaining in the closed position (i.e., stiff and rigid laminates may be biased toward a flat or unsealed position).

(22) The use of a lighter weight kraft paper (e.g., 25-35 pounds/3000 square feet) may increase a laminate's closure end seal integrity by decreasing the laminate's resistance to bending or curling toward the closed position. In addition, the lighter weight kraft paper may not significantly degrade the beneficial properties of the laminate so that the laminate's functionality is not comprised. A paper weight that is roughly 30 pounds/3000 square feet may provide an optimal level of seal integrity vs. laminate properties. The present invention, however, is not limited to the use of a lighter weight kraft paper (or to the use of a kraft paper in general).

(23) The laminate **200** additionally may include an insulation material **202**. The insulation material **202** may be a fibrous material (e.g., fiberglass, mineral wool, refractory ceramic fiber, chopped strand fiber glass, etc.) or a foam (e.g., phenolic foam, polyisocyanurate, polyolefin, polystyrene, polyurethane), a polymer, foam glass, microporous insulation, or any other material that provides insulative properties. When cold fluid is passed through the duct, the insulation material **202** may prevent water vapor from condensing on the pipes and causing the associated problems described herein. Again, if the closure end **108** becomes unsealed, however, the water vapor barrier may be circumvented as water vapor may freely flow between the unsealed portion of the laminate.

(24) The foil or metallized polymeric film sheet **208**, the scrim **206**, the porous media sheet **204**, and the insulation material **202** may be bonded or adhered together using one or more adhesives (not shown). The adhesive or adhesives used may be contact type, pressure sensitive, heat seal, etc. and may include one or more additives to enhance the performance, dimensional stability, moisture resistance, handleability, fire and smoke propagation resistance, and/or durability of the laminate **200**. Examples of adhesives that can be used include, but are not limited to, melamine, urea formaldehyde, phenolic, polyurethane, acrylic, latex, and acrylo-nitrile. Additional adhesives that can be used may include adhesives that can migrate into the porous media sheet **204** to improve the physical characteristics of the laminate **200** (e.g., improve UV stability, flame spread resistance, mold growth resistance, etc.). Examples of such migrating adhesives include colloidal silica or alumina, sodium or potassium silicate, ammonium phosphate stabilized with zinc oxide, magnesia

or alumina; borax, and oxi-chloride stabilized with zinc oxide or magnesia.

(25) FIG. 3 shows a duct insulation product **300** with a closure flap **310** according to embodiments of the present invention. While referred to as a duct insulation product, it is contemplated that the product may be positioned around or within various different paths and/or other structures including, but not limited to, ducts, pipes, tubes, channels, passages, etc. While shown as having a generally circular shape, it will be appreciated that the insulation product **100** may have other shapes to fit about ducts, pipes, and/or other structures having non-circular cross-sections. Duct insulation product **300** may be similar to duct insulation product **100** and may include features or characteristics of any of the duct insulation product **100** illustrated and described previously. For example, the duct insulation product **300** may include an insulation material **304**. Insulation material **304** may be the same or similar to insulation material **104**. The duct insulation product **300** may include a moisture barrier material **302**. Moisture barrier material **302** may be the same or similar to laminate **102**.

(26) The moisture barrier material **302** may be coupled with the insulation material **304**. The insulation material **304** may form an inner surface **305** of the duct insulation product **300**. The moisture barrier material **302** may form an outer surface **306** of the duct insulation product **300**. The moisture barrier material **302** and the insulation material **304** of the duct insulation product **300** may include a length that is at least double a width of the moisture barrier material **302** and the insulation material **304**, respectively. In embodiments, the length of the material may be at least triple, quadruple, five times, ten times, fifteen times, twenty times, or greater than the width of the material. The width of the material may be greater than or about 48 inches, greater than or about 60 inches, greater than or about 72 inches, or more.

(27) The moisture barrier material **302** may include at least one closure flap **310** along at least one side of the moisture barrier material **302**. The closure flap **310** may extend beyond a periphery of the insulation material **304** along at least one side of the insulation material **304**. Specifically, the closure flap **310** may be formed by a portion of the moisture barrier material **302** extending beyond the insulation material **304**. The closure flap **310** may extend along an entire length of the at least one side of the insulation material **304**. In embodiments, the moisture barrier material **302** may extend beyond the insulation material **304** along two or more edges to form two or more closure flaps **310**. For example, the moisture barrier material **302** may extend beyond the insulation material **304** along parallel edges. Alternatively, the moisture barrier material **302** may extend beyond the insulation material **304** along perpendicular or adjacent edges. It is also contemplated that the moisture barrier material **302** may extend beyond the insulation material **304** along three sides or four sides. If the closure flap **310** does not extend beyond a periphery of the insulation material **304**, the duct insulation product **300** may not provide as strong a seal as if the closure flap **310** does extend beyond a periphery of the insulation material **304**. As will be discussed below, an adhesive material **312** on the closure flap **310** may not adhere as well to the insulation material **304**, but may adhere better to the moisture barrier material **302**.

(28) As previously discussed with regard to FIG. 1, the insulation material **304** may be or include fiberglass, mineral wool, refractory ceramic fiber, chopped strand fiber glass, phenolic foam, polyisocyanurate, polyolefin, polystyrene, polyurethane, a polymer, foam glass, microporous insulation, or any other material that provides insulation. Thus, in embodiments, the duct insulation product **300** may be flexible depending on the material(s) included in the insulation material **304**. In other embodiments, the duct insulation product **300** may be rigid. Depending on the application, a flexible material may be employed instead of a rigid material. For example, a flexible material may be desirable for a round duct and a rigid material may be desirable for a rectangular duct.

(29) As also previously discussed with regard to FIG. 2, the moisture barrier material **302** may include a plurality of layers. For example, the moisture barrier material **302** may include an outer layer composed of a foil or metallized polymeric film sheet (e.g., a foil), a scrim that may include a mesh of a plurality of fibers, and a porous media sheet (e.g., a kraft). In embodiments, the moisture

barrier material **302** may be or include a foil scrim paper kraft laminate, a fiberglass reinforced facing, a poly facing (e.g., polyisocyanurate), an all service jacket (ASJ) facing, etc.

(30) At least a portion of an inner surface **305** of the closure flap **310** may include an adhesive material **312**. The adhesive material **312** may be any glue, cement, mucilage, or paste. In embodiments, the adhesive material **312** may be or include double-sided tape, plant resin (e.g., Mastic), hook and loop fastener (e.g., Velcro®), etc. The adhesive material **312** may be able to bond the closure flap **310** to a lateral edge portion **316** of the moisture barrier material **302**. The lateral edge portion **316** may extend parallel and adjacent to the adhesive material **312**. The adhesive material **312** may be disposed along substantially an entire length of the at least one closure flap **310**. However, it is also contemplated that the adhesive material **312** may be disposed intermittently or discontinuously along the length of the at least one closure flap **310**.

(31) As further discussed below, it is contemplated that a plurality of duct insulation products **300** may be assembled together to insulate a length of ductwork. In such embodiments, the adhesive material **312** may bond the closure flap **310** of a first duct insulation product to a lateral edge portion **316** of the moisture barrier material **302** of a second duct insulation product such that two duct insulation products are bonded and sealed together. In embodiments, an additional adhesive (not shown) may be disposed on the lateral edge portion **316** to increase the strength of the bond between the closure flap **310** and the lateral edge portion **316**.

(32) The size of the adhesive material **312** may be dependent on the insulation application. In embodiments, the adhesive material **312** may be characterized by a thickness of greater than or about 0.01 mm, such as greater than or about 0.1 mm, greater than or about 0.5 mm, greater than or about 1.0 mm, greater than or about 2.5 mm, greater than or about 5.0 mm, greater than or about 10.0 mm, greater than or about 25.0 mm, greater than or about 50.0 mm, greater than or about 75.0 mm, greater than or about 100.0 mm, greater than or about 150.0 mm, greater than or about 200.0 mm, or more.

(33) The adhesive material **312** may be characterized by a width of less than or about 8.0 inches. For example, the adhesive material **312** may be characterized by a width of less than or about 7.5 inches, less than or about 7.0 inches, less than or about 6.5 inches, less than or about 6.0 inches, less than or about 5.5 inches, less than or about 5.0 inches, less than or about 4.5 inches, less than or about 4.0 inches, less than or about 3.5 inches, less than or about 3.0 inches, less than or about 2.5 inches, less than or about 2.0 inches, less than or about 1.5 inches, less than or about 1.0 inches, less than or about 0.5 inches. In embodiments, the adhesive material **312** may be characterized by a width of between about 0.5 inches and about 8.0 inches. The adhesive material **312** may be characterized by a peel strength of greater than or about ounces per inch.

(34) A release liner (not shown) may be disposed over to the adhesive material **312**. The release liner may be removably adhered to the adhesive material **312** on the closure flap **310** to protect the adhesive material **312** prior to installation (e.g., from degradation and from sticking to undesired surfaces prior to installation). In embodiments, the release liner may be paper-based or poly-based. In embodiments, the release liner may be silicon treated.

(35) In embodiments, the closure flap **310** may be further secured in addition to the adhesive material **312**. For example, a second adhesive material (such as a tape) may be applied to the outer surface of the duct insulation product **300**, such as over the moisture barrier material **302**. Additionally or alternatively, one or more fasteners, such as staples, may be used to secure the closure flap **310**. However, the use of a second adhesive or fasteners, such as staples, may not be necessary due to the adhesive material **312**.

(36) In embodiments, the duct insulation product **300** may be rolled up prior to installation. For example, the duct insulation product **300** may be rolled up around a spool or other storage/transport device. The adhesive material **312** may be applied to the closure flap **310** prior to rolling up the duct insulation product **300**. That is, the adhesive material **312** may be pre-applied adhesive. Pre-applied adhesive may refer to adhesive material **312** that does not need to be applied on-site. Pre-

applied adhesive may streamline the installation process of the duct insulation product **300** as the adhesive material **312** of the present disclosure may obviate the application of staples and/or adhesive while installing the duct insulation product **300**.

(37) FIG. **4** shows an isometric view of duct insulation system **400** with a shiplap closure flap **410** according to embodiments of the present invention. While referred to as a duct insulation system, it is contemplated that the system may be positioned around various different fluid paths and/or other structures including, but not limited to, ducts, pipes, tubes, channels, passages, etc. The duct insulation system **400** may include a plurality of duct insulation products **401**. The duct insulation products **401** may be the same or similar to duct insulation products **100** or **300**. For example, each duct insulation product **401** may include an insulation material **404** and a moisture barrier material **402** coupled with the insulation material **404**. Similar to duct insulation product **300**, the moisture barrier material **402** may extend beyond a periphery of the insulation material **404** along at least one side of the insulation material **404** to form a closure flap **410**. At least a portion of an inner surface **411** of the closure flap **410** may include an adhesive material **412**. The insulation material **404**, the moisture barrier material **402**, and the adhesive material **412** may be the same or similar to the insulation material **304**, the moisture barrier material **302**, and the adhesive material **312**, respectively, as previously described.

(38) As previously discussed, the adhesive material **412** of the closure flap **410** of a first duct insulation product may couple with and secure a second duct insulation product. In embodiments and as illustrated in FIG. **4**, a first end **420** of each duct insulation product **401** may be defined by a male shiplap profile **421**. A second end **422** opposite and/or adjacent the first end **420** of each duct insulation product **401** may be defined by a female shiplap profile **421**. The closure flap **410** and the adhesive material **412** may be defined on at least one inner surface **411** of the second end **422** of each duct insulation product **401**. That is, the adhesive material **412** may be defined on an inner surface **411** of the female shiplap profile **421**, such that the male shiplap profile **423** bonds to and is secured with the female shiplap profile **421**. In embodiments, one or more ends of the duct insulation product **401** may define both a male shiplap profile **423** and a female shiplap profile **421** such that the profiles of two duct insulation products **401** correspond and complement one another to provide a more secure fitment.

(39) FIG. **5** shows a duct insulation manufacturing method according to embodiments of the present invention. At operation **505**, the method may include coupling an insulation material to a moisture barrier material. The insulation material and the moisture barrier material may form an insulation product. The moisture barrier material may extend beyond a periphery of the insulation material along at least one edge to form at least one closure flap. The closure flap may result from the moisture barrier material being larger and extending beyond a periphery of the insulation material along at least one edge prior to the two materials being coupled together. Alternatively and/or additionally, the closure flap may be formed by removing a portion of the insulation material such that the moisture barrier material may extend beyond a periphery of the insulation material along at least one edge.

(40) As previously discussed, in embodiments, the moisture barrier material may extend beyond the insulation material along two or more edges to form two or more closure flaps. For example, the moisture barrier material may extend beyond the insulation material along two edges, three edges, four edges, or more to form two closure flaps, three closure flaps, four closure flaps, or more, respectively.

(41) At operation **510**, the method **500** may include disposing an adhesive material on the at least one closure flap. The adhesive material may be similar to adhesive material **312** previously described. For example, the adhesive material may be characterized by a thickness of between about 0.01 mm and about 200.0 mm. The adhesive material may be characterized by a width of between 0.01 mm and about 200.0 mm. Further, the adhesive material may be disposed along substantially an entire length of the at least one closure flap. However, it is also contemplated that the adhesive

material may be disposed intermittently or discontinuously along the length of the at least one closure flap. In embodiments with two or more closure flaps, the method **500** may include disposing the adhesive material on any of number of the closure flaps, such as two or more closure flaps.

(42) At operation **515**, the method **500** may include applying a release liner to the adhesive material. The release liner may protect the adhesive material prior to application (i.e., installation of the duct product). The release liner may be the same as or similar to release liner of duct insulation products **300** or **401**. The release liner may be removably adhered to the adhesive material on the closure flap to protect the adhesive material prior to installation.

(43) In embodiments, the method **500** may include rolling the insulation material and the moisture barrier material for storage after applying release liner at operation **520**. As previously discussed, the adhesive material may be applied prior to storage and/or on-site installation. The pre-applied adhesive material may increase efficiency in installing duct insulation products as the need for fastening, such as stapling, and applying an outer adhesive is obviated.

(44) Embodiments of the present disclosure may allow for easier and quicker installation of duct insulation products. In conventional designs, the closure flap, commonly referred to as a staple flap, does not have an adhesive. Instead, the staple flap is secured by fastening, such as with staples, and then an outer seal is disposed over the top of the staples. In embodiments of the present disclosure, the closure flap includes an adhesive already disposed on the closure flap. During installation, a user may simply remove a release liner or prep the adhesive and stick the adhesive to the insulation product. Closure flaps of the present technology eliminate the need for staples and an outer seal.

(45) The methods, systems, and devices discussed herein are examples. Various configurations may omit, substitute, or add various procedures or components as appropriate. For instance, in alternative configurations, the methods may be performed in an order different from that described, and/or various stages may be added, omitted, and/or combined. Also, features described with respect to certain configurations may be combined in various other configurations. Different aspects and elements of the configurations may be combined in a similar manner. Also, technology evolves and, thus, many of the elements are examples and do not limit the scope of the disclosure or claims. Additionally, the techniques discussed herein may provide differing results with different types of context awareness classifiers.

(46) While illustrative and presently preferred embodiments of the disclosed systems, methods, and machine-readable media have been described in detail herein, it is to be understood that the inventive concepts may be otherwise variously embodied and employed, and that the appended claims are intended to be construed to include such variations, except as limited by the prior art.

(47) Unless defined otherwise, all technical and scientific terms used herein have the same meaning as commonly or conventionally understood. As used herein, the articles “a” and “an” refer to one or to more than one (i.e., to at least one) of the grammatical object of the article. By way of example, “an element” means one element or more than one element. “About” and/or “approximately” as used herein when referring to a measurable value such as an amount, a temporal duration, and the like, encompasses variations of $\pm 20\%$ or $\pm 10\%$, $\pm 5\%$, or $+0.1\%$ from the specified value, as such variations are appropriate to in the context of the systems, devices, circuits, methods, and other implementations described herein. “Substantially” as used herein when referring to a measurable value such as an amount, a temporal duration, a physical attribute (such as frequency), and the like, also encompasses variations of $\pm 20\%$ or $\pm 10\%$, $\pm 5\%$, or $+0.1\%$ from the specified value, as such variations are appropriate to in the context of the systems, devices, circuits, methods, and other implementations described herein.

(48) Where a range of values is provided, it is understood that each intervening value, to the smallest fraction of the unit of the lower limit, unless the context clearly dictates otherwise, between the upper and lower limits of that range is also specifically disclosed. Any narrower range between any stated values or unstated intervening values in a stated range and any other stated or

intervening value in that stated range is encompassed. The upper and lower limits of those smaller ranges may independently be included or excluded in the range, and each range where either, neither, or both limits are included in the smaller ranges is also encompassed within the technology, subject to any specifically excluded limit in the stated range. Where the stated range includes one or both of the limits, ranges excluding either or both of those included limits are also included.

Claims

1. A duct insulation product comprising: an insulation material; a moisture barrier material coupled with the insulation material, the moisture barrier material forming an outer surface of the duct insulation product and covering an entire exterior surface of the insulation material, wherein the outer surface of the moisture barrier material comprises a foil facing or a poly facing, wherein: the moisture barrier material extends continuously between a first edge and an opposed second edge, and comprises at least one closure flap along the first edge, the second edge, or both the first edge and the second edge of the moisture barrier material, the closure flap extending beyond a periphery of the insulation material along at least two adjacent edges of the insulation material; and at least a portion of an inner surface of the closure flap comprises an adhesive material disposed along the at least two adjacent edges of the insulation material; and a release liner applied atop the adhesive material along the at least two adjacent edges of the insulation material.
2. The duct insulation product of claim 1, wherein: the duct insulation product is flexible.
3. The duct insulation product of claim 1, wherein: the insulation material comprises fiberglass.
4. The duct insulation product of claim 1, wherein: the moisture barrier material comprises a foil scrim kraft paper laminate, fiberglass reinforced faces, a poly facing, polyisocyanurate, an all service jacketing facing.
5. The duct insulation product of claim 1, wherein: the adhesive material is characterized by a thickness of greater than or about 0.01 mm.
6. The duct insulation product of claim 1, wherein: the adhesive material is characterized by a peel strength of greater than or about 60 ounces per inch.
7. The duct insulation product of claim 1, wherein: the adhesive material is disposed along substantially an entire length of the moisture barrier material.
8. The duct insulation product of claim 1, wherein: the adhesive material comprises double-sided tape.
9. The duct insulation product of claim 1, wherein: the duct insulation product is rolled up prior to installation; and the adhesive material is applied to the closure flap prior to rolling up the insulation material.
10. A duct insulation system comprising: a plurality of duct insulation products, each duct insulation product comprising an insulation material and a moisture barrier material coupled with the insulation material, wherein: the moisture barrier material of each duct insulation product covers an entire exterior surface of the insulation material of the respective duct insulation product; the moisture barrier material extends continuously between a first edge and an opposed second edge, and beyond a periphery of the insulation material along the first edge, the second edge, or both the first edge and the second edge of the insulation material to form a closure flap that extends beyond a periphery of the insulation material along at least two adjacent edges of the insulation material; at least a portion of an inner surface of the closure flap along both of the at least two adjacent edges of the insulation material comprises an adhesive material; and the adhesive material of the closure flap of a first duct insulation product couples with and secures a second duct insulation product.
11. The duct insulation system of claim 10, wherein: the duct insulation system is positioned around one or more ducts.
12. The duct insulation system of claim 10, wherein: the adhesive material is characterized by a

thickness of greater than or about 0.01 mm; and the adhesive material is characterized by a width of less than or about 8.0 inches.

13. The duct insulation system of claim 10, wherein: the moisture barrier material comprises a length at least double a width of the moisture barrier material.

14. The duct insulation system of claim 10, wherein: the adhesive material is disposed along substantially an entire length of the moisture barrier material.

15. The duct insulation system of claim 10, wherein: the first edge of each duct insulation product is defined by a male shiplap profile; and the second edge of each duct insulation product is defined by a female shiplap profile, wherein the closure flap and the adhesive material are defined on at least one inner surface of the second edge.

16. A duct insulation manufacturing method comprising: coupling an insulation material to a moisture barrier material to form an insulation product, the moisture barrier material forming an outer surface of the duct insulation, wherein: the insulation material comprises a plurality of planar segments that are pivotable relative to one another; the outer surface of the moisture barrier material comprises a foil facing or a poly facing; the moisture barrier material extends continuously between a first edge and an opposed second edge, and beyond a periphery of the insulation material along the first edge, the second edge, or both the first edge and the second edge to form at least one closure flap; the at least one closure flap extending beyond a periphery of the insulation material along at least two adjacent edges of the insulation material; and the moisture barrier material covers an entire exterior surface of the insulation material; disposing an adhesive material on the at least one closure flap along the at least two adjacent edges of the insulation material; and applying a release liner to the adhesive material along the at least two adjacent edges of the insulation material, wherein the release liner protects the adhesive material prior to application.

17. The duct insulation manufacturing method of claim 16, further comprising: rolling the insulation material and the moisture barrier material for storage after applying release liner.

18. The duct insulation manufacturing method of claim 16, wherein: the moisture barrier material extends beyond the insulation material along two or more edges to form two or more closure flaps; and further comprising disposing the adhesive material on two or more closure flaps.

19. The duct insulation manufacturing method of claim 16, wherein: the adhesive material is characterized by a thickness of between about 0.01 mm and about 200.0 mm; and the adhesive material is characterized by a width of between about 0.5 inches and about 8.0 inches.

20. The duct insulation manufacturing method of claim 16, wherein: the adhesive material is disposed along substantially an entire length of the at least one closure flap.
